DAY 3 | WEDNESDAY, OCT 7, 2026

Audio Basics.

Make it sound as good as it looks: levels, clean voice and music.

10:00 a.m. - 12:00 p.m. | Multan Office

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WELCOME BACK

Yesterday in 30 seconds.

1. Timeline anatomy: V tracks, A tracks, playhead
2. Insert (comma) and Overwrite (period)
3. Razor (C), Ripple (B), Rolling (N)
4. Slip (Y) and Slide (U)
5. Rough cut of an interview

Share one thing you practiced yesterday.

TODAY'S AGENDA

Two hours, eight steps.

10:00	Recap and questions	10 min
10:10	Why audio matters and how sound works	15 min
10:25	Levels, meters and decibels	25 min
10:50	Short break	10 min
11:00	Essential Sound and Enhance Speech	25 min
11:25	Music, fades and ducking	10 min
11:35	Hands on: clean and mix a voiceover	20 min
11:55	Recap and homework	5 min

THE MINDSET

Audio is half the video.

1

Clarity

If viewers cannot hear the message, the video fails.

2

Emotion

Music and sound shape how a scene feels.

3

Quality

Clean sound makes your work look professional.

HOW SOUND WORKS

Three layers of a mix.

Dialogue

The voice. Always the star.



Music

Sets the mood. Stays under the voice.



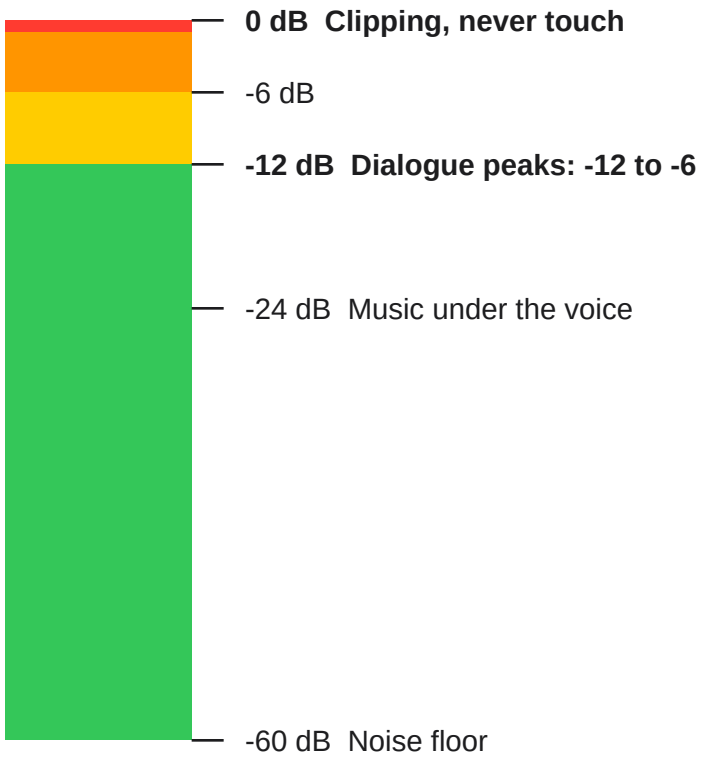
Effects + ambience

Adds realism: footsteps, room tone.



LEVELS

Reading the meters.



- dB means decibels, a unit of loudness
- Peaks that hit 0 dB distort. This is clipping
- Aim for dialogue peaks between -12 and -6 dB
- Keep music well below the voice
- Boosting quiet audio also boosts noise

ADJUSTING

Three ways to set volume.

G

Audio Gain

Select a clip and press G to set gain in dB.

Drag

Rubber band

Drag the volume line on the clip up or down.

Ctrl/Cmd + click

Keyframes

Ctrl/Cmd + click the line to add points and shape changes.

Watch the Audio Meters panel while you play.

ESSENTIAL SOUND

Tag first, then fix.

D

Dialogue

Voices and interviews

M

Music

Background tracks

S

SFX

Sound effects

A

Ambience

Room tone and atmosphere

Open it: Window > Essential Sound. Select a clip, then choose its type.

AI AUDIO

Enhance Speech.

How to use it

- Select the dialogue clip
- Essential Sound > tag it as Dialogue
- Turn on Enhance Speech and run Enhance
- Adjust the mix amount to taste

Good practice

- Works best on speech, not music
- Listen on headphones for artifacts
- Do not push it to the maximum by habit
- Keep a copy of the original clip

CLEAN VOICE

Five steps to clear dialogue.

1

Tag

Mark as Dialogue

>

2

Repair

Reduce noise, hum, reverb

>

3

Enhance

Run Enhance Speech

>

4

Level

Peaks at -12 to -6 dB

>

5

Check

Listen on headphones

MUSIC

Choose it, place it, fade it.

Choose

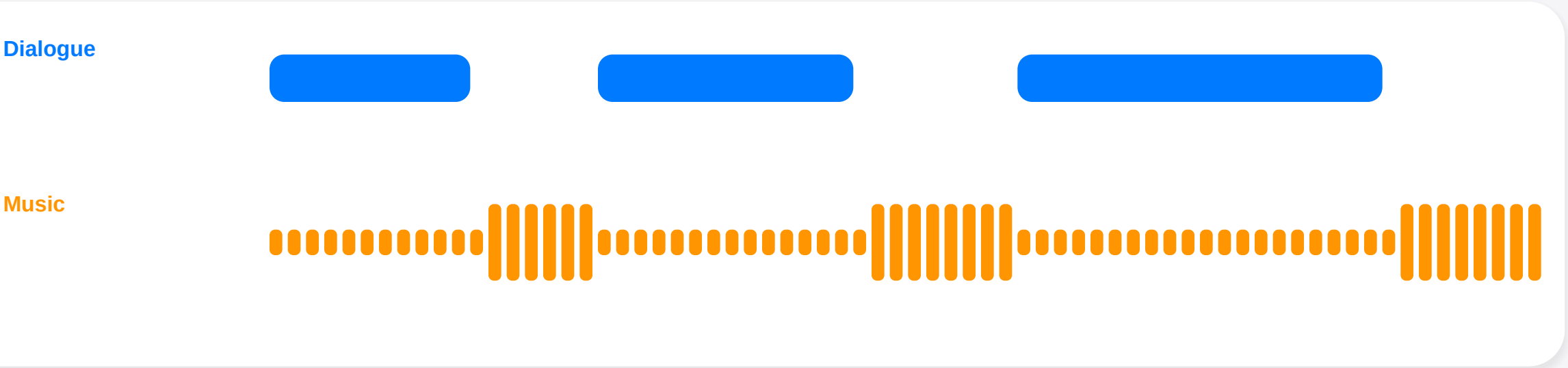
- Match the mood and the audience
- Use licensed or royalty free music
- Avoid music with lyrics under speech
- Check that it can loop or trim cleanly

Place and fade

- Fade in at the start, fade out at the end
- Use Constant Power for smooth crossfades
- Ctrl/Cmd + Shift + D adds the default audio transition
- Keep music lower than the voice

AUTO DUCKING

Music steps aside for the voice.



Set it up

Tag the music clip as Music in Essential Sound, turn on Ducking, choose Duck Against Dialogue, then click Generate Keyframes.

SHORTCUTS

Speed up your audio work.

G	Audio Gain
Ctrl/Cmd + L	Link / unlink clips
Ctrl/Cmd+Shift+D	Default audio transition
S	Snapping on / off
M	Add a marker
Space	Play / pause
Shift + Delete	Ripple delete
Ctrl/Cmd + S	Save

HANDS ON

Clean and mix a voiceover.

- [ ] Import the voiceover and a music track
- [ ] Tag them: Dialogue and Music
- [ ] Reduce noise and run Enhance Speech on the voice
- [ ] Set voice peaks between -12 and -6 dB
- [ ] Turn on Ducking and generate keyframes for the music
- [ ] Fade the music out, listen on headphones, save as v04

QUICK CHECK

Five questions.

1. What does dB measure?
2. What happens when audio hits 0 dB?
3. Why do we tag clips in Essential Sound?
4. What does Enhance Speech do?
5. What is ducking, and when do we use it?

RECAP

What you learned today.

Covered

- How sound is layered
- Levels, meters, dB
- Essential Sound, Enhance Speech
- Music, fades, auto ducking

Homework

- Mix a 60 second video with voice and music
- Keep voice peaks at -12 to -6 dB
- Bring your diary tomorrow

Tomorrow

- Titles and Motion
- Essential Graphics and transitions
- Speed changes, basic keyframes